HARBOURLIGHT MEDIA

Clearance Code: Consumer Credit

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1. Purpose and scope

This code sets out when and where Harbourlight Media may transmit advertising for consumer credit. It applies to every spot of every campaign in the category on Harbourlight One, Harbourlight Sport, Harbourlight Drama and Harbourlight Life.

A campaign is cleared in full only when its copy is acceptable and every booked spot meets the scheduling rules in sections 4 to 7; when some spots do not, only its compliant spots can be cleared. The clearance desk checks both, and a Clearance Controller decides, as the Advertising Clearance Policy describes.

The code is published to agencies and may be quoted to anyone who asks.

2. Products covered

This code covers advertising for consumer credit: credit cards, personal loans, buy now pay later plans, car finance and short-term loans.

It also covers advertising by a broker or a comparison service that introduces viewers to consumer credit.

3. How this code is applied

The rules in sections 4 to 7 apply to every booked spot of a campaign for consumer credit, on the broadcast day the spot belongs to.

Times in this code are written on the ordinary 24-hour clock. The Scheduling and Audience Rules explain how they are placed on the broadcast day, and what a centre break, an end break, in and adjacent mean.

A spot in a centre break is in the programme around it. A spot in an end break is adjacent to the programme before it and to the programme after it.

A spot that meets every rule may be transmitted. A spot that breaks a rule may not be transmitted, and is recorded against every rule it breaks.

4. Restricted hours

Spots for this category may not be transmitted between 06:00 and 19:00.

The restricted hours apply to every break, including a break within live sport coverage.

5. The under-18 audience

Spots may not be transmitted in or adjacent to a programme whose under-18 audience index is 125 or more.

The index is the forecast under-18 audience index that Harbourlight's audience planning team publishes for each programme before the booking week begins, as the programme schedule shows it.

A spot in an end break is tested against both programmes, and breaks this rule if either of them is indexed at or above the figure in this section.

6. Programmes made for children

Spots may not be transmitted in or adjacent to a programme made for children.

A programme is made for children when the programme schedule marks it so, whatever its under-18 audience index.

The rule covers the end breaks before and after such a programme as well as its centre breaks.

7. How many spots, and how far apart

No more than 5 spots of one campaign may be transmitted on one channel in one broadcast day.

Two spots of one campaign on one channel must be at least 15 minutes apart.

Both rules are applied per campaign, per channel and per broadcast day, to the spots in the order they are transmitted. Every booked spot counts towards the limit, whether or not it breaks another rule.

The separation is measured from the campaign's previous spot on the same channel in the same broadcast day. Two spots of one campaign in one break are zero minutes apart and are transmitted in the order of their spot references.

8. Copy requirements

The copy of every campaign in this category must meet these requirements, and the issue guides say how the clearance desk checks each kind of claim.

- Copy that states an interest rate, a repayment, an interest-free period or any other figure about the cost of credit must show the representative APR and the representative example, at least as prominently as that figure.
- The copy must not claim that credit is guaranteed, available without checks, or approved in minutes.
- The copy must not urge viewers to borrow now, or present borrowing as a way out of money worries.
- Copy for a buy now pay later plan must say that missed repayments can affect a credit rating.
- Copy for a short-term loan must carry the risk warning about the cost of short-term borrowing.

9. Standing restrictions on every cleared spot

Every cleared spot in this category is cleared subject to these standing restrictions:

- A cleared spot may be transmitted only on the channel, broadcast day and break its certificate shows.
- The copy is cleared as submitted under its clock number, and any change needs a new clearance.
- If a programme's forecast index is revised before transmission, a spot in or adjacent to it must be checked again against section 5.
- The representative APR must stay on screen for as long as any cost of credit is shown or spoken.

10. Re-booking a withdrawn spot

Move a spot withdrawn under section 4 to a break outside the restricted hours, usually in the evening. A break that begins at the moment the restricted hours end is outside them and may be used. A spot withdrawn under section 7 may move to another broadcast day or channel, where it counts with the campaign's other spots there. Send the new break to the clearance desk with the campaign and spot references, and the desk checks it against this code before it is transmitted.

11. Questions about this code

Agencies can ask about the consumer credit code through the Agency Liaison assigned to them. Questions about a particular campaign are answered only for the agency that booked it.